

SATHYASHODHANA RANGA SAMUDAYA TRUST, HEGGODU (R).

A CULTURAL TRUST
JANAMANADATA DIVISION

A REPORT – 2018-19



A scene from Kurukshethra (Janamanadata 2018-19), Dir. by Dr. M. Ganesha

Introduction:

Sathyashodhana Ranga Samudaya, previously known as Janamanadata, is a cultural trust founded and registered in October 2015 and based at Heggodu, Sagara taluk, Shivamogga District, Karnataka. It grew out of the activities and initiatives of Janamanadata, a theatre group which came into existence in May 2005 and today includes Janamanadata as a division. The Trust, at one level, strives towards realising the ideals of liberty, equality, fraternity, and social justice. At another, practical, level, it aims at providing a platform for enhancing their theatre craft and art for young theatre activists. The group works under the leadership of Dr. M. Ganesha, a versatile and highly experienced theatre practitioner and teacher.

Sathyashodhana Ranga Samudaya has an impressive list of achievements to show so far. Between 2005 and 2018, through its arm Janamanadata, it put up 10 theatre productions covering a wide range of forms, styles, themes, source-languages like Shraddha mattu Hanate, Uchalya, Rahasya Vishwa, Tabarana Kathe, Babasaheb Ambedkar, Sooryana Kudure, Oorukeri, Baduku Bayalu, Sathyashodhaka, Odire, and Kurukshethra. Of these, some were original Kannada plays, some Kannada translations of plays from different languages, and some adaptations of literary works again from different languages. Some productions were specific to a particular season or year, while

some were continued over more than one season/year owing to popular demand or their social relevance. Janamanadata's productions of Oorukeri, Baduku Bayalu, Sathyashodhaka, Babasaheb Ambedkar, and Kurukshethra have been hailed as landmark works in the history of Kannada theatre.

Up to the end of year 2018-19, the group has put up 685 performances in and outside Karnataka. The productions are designed in such a way that they can be performed in a wide variety of physical spaces differing from one another as regards stage area, structure, seating capacity, infrastructure, etc.

The Janamanadata theatre troupe began with 7 actors, and has 17 today. These perform all back-stage and off-stage work as well as on-stage work. They conduct all the activities before and during the performance-tour pooling together their own finances and at the end of the tour share the collections on an equal basis. A certain part of the income earned every season/year is utilised for purchase of essential theatre equipment.

In its Fourteen years of existence, Janamanadata has visited all 30 districts of Karnataka. Though it has not performed in every district every year, it has performed in each geographical zone or revenue division every year.

JANAMANADATA: AN OVERVIEW

- A theatre group established in 2005; has grown from a band of 7 to 17 artistes now;
- These artistes handle all on-stage, backstage and off-stage work;
- They all share all the initial investment every season and also share all the earnings every season-end;
- 1 or 2 productions rehearsed over a month and tour shows held over a 2-to-3 month period every season;
- One show every 25-75 kms. of travel and a performance almost every day, which works out to about 45-55 shows over 60 days of tour;
- A total distance of 69150 kilometres covered so far on show-tours.
- 685 shows of 10 productions so far, to an estimated total audience of 6,00590;
- 90% of the shows have been held in rural Karnataka, in taluka towns, hobali centres, villages and hamlets;
- Performed in all districts of Karnataka;
- Both local and invited directors from outside have worked on the productions, some of which have even taken form under collective direction from the entire group;
- The group has not applied for or received any State or Central Government grant thus far;
- It has sustained itself so far through investments made by the artistes themselves, donations from patrons, charges paid by show-hosting organisations.



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SATHYASHODHANA RANGA SAMUDAYA, HEGGODU (R).

JANAMANADATA 2018-19.

The group toured its production of Kurukshethra in April-2018 to period of March-2019. It repeated Kurukshethra this season first of all because of its great popularity and public demand.

Technical details of the production Kurukshethra are as follows:

KURUKSHETHRA

A theatre production based on a composite script incorporating sections from different individual plays written on the same episode by eminent Kannada writers B. Puttaswamayya and Kuvempu, productions based on the same episode created by P. Vajrappa and Kalloor Shrinivas.

Design & Direction: Dr. M. Ganesha

Music: Arunkumar M.

SYNOPSIS:

The production covers the series of events in the Mahabharata beginning with Krishna's embarking on a peace mission to Duryodhana and the failure of the mission; the insults that Krishna suffers at the Kauravas Court; the discussions and debates that take place within the Pandava and the Kaurava families themselves; Draupadi's expression of an unquenchable wrath and demand for avenging her humiliation, and culminating in the great war. The events all throw light on ideas of dharma and adharma, peace and violence, revenge and reconciliation, personal preferences and collective duties, the virtues and weaknesses of human beings in general. Conceived and staged in the Company natak format, the production uses stylised acting and dialogue rendition, songs and musical accompaniment, elaborate sets and costumes.

Director's Note :



In my native place Timmappana halli and in surrounding village, I enjoyed watching enactment of Kurukshethra, Ramayana, Danashuraveerakarna, Rajavikarama etc. that were performed annually when I came to Bangalore for my higher studies, my ties with company theater were left behind. When I look back and think about how I left then, watching company theater, I feel amused. I wouldn't miss even the all-night rehearsals of these plays. As I was a kid I wouldn't get any opportunities to act but no one could withhold my opportunity to watch those plays. Saturdays and Sundays being holidays, it was my turn to look after the cattle. I used to rehearse these stories with my fellow cattle men. The mud from the wells that were being dug was our "Aharya" (make - up), the bamboo sticks were our bows and arrows, Worn out plastic picture the weapon (gada), the surrounding lakes become rivers and seas, The greenery was a dense forest, we the characters of *Ramayana* and *Mahabharatha*. I had never thought that the games, which we played as kids. Would become the texts for my future studies. Ninasam has thought me these playful games in our theater course. But with discipline. In the year 2014-15 Ninasam trained student with different texts of *Kurukshethra*. Though the group was of young students, their singing and acting was of professional level. The nearby villagers come in crowds to watch this play. I had thought of doing this play much earlier for Janamanadata. But it couldn't be possible for many reasons. Now, the actor Manju Sirigere, Nagaraja Sirsi, Sharath S Mysore, Uma Y.G Kolar, Shrinivasamurthy Tumakuru, along with help of other actors and technicians, came together to recreate this play for Janamanadata.



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MEMBERS OF THE JANAMANADATA TROUPE 2018-19.

Director/s: Dr. M. Ganesha.

Actors: Y Manjunath, Nagaraj Sirsi, Uma Y G, Halebasappa, Manjappa Huligi, Shivaraja, Vani Reddy, Poornima, Sathish Chauhan, Basavaraj, Kriyappa Kavaluru, Peerappa H Doddamani, Naveen Prathap, Rajath, Shruthi V, Mahantesh, Durga,

Technical Help: Manju Kodagu, Arun Kumar M, Dingri Naresh, Shrinivasamurthy, Sundaresh, Y Manjunath, Vidya Shivamogga, Ranganath, Shrikanth, Sujatha, Sriharsha Gobhat, Phaniyamma.

Music: Arun Kumar M.

Music Operation: Ravikumar Benni, Bharath Dingri, Raghava Kammar, Basavaraj.

Lighting: Satish Chauhan.

Dr. M. Ganesha : Dr. M. Ganesha did his Masters in Kannada from Bangalore University. He completed theatre training at Ninasam Theater Institute, Heggodu and then got appointed as a faculty at Ninasam. He received Doctorate from Kuvempu University for his thesis on *Kannada Rangabhoomiya Hosa Sadhyathegalu* (New possibilities in Kannada theatre). An actor, director and organizer, he has worked in many theatre troupes including Ninasam Tirugata, Charaka, Kinnaramela, Protheo, Spandana, Kagodu Rangamancha, Navu Mandya. the central *Sangeet Natak Academi* has Awarded him *Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar-2007*. He was also awarded the *Best Actor* award for the movie *Dhali* in *Bellimandala and Ambegalu film festival*. He worked as a director of Rangayana, Shivamogga between June -2017 to Sep-2019. Currently he is working as the Principal of Ninasam Theater Intitute, Heggodu.



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JANAMANADATA SHOWS SCHEDULE

2018-19.

01-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Shivamogga
04-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Theerthahalli
05-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Theerthahalli
06-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Hirisave
07-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Mattanavile
08-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Kunigal
09-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Nilattalli
11-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Galigenahalli
13-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Kalamarahalli
14-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Kataveeranahalli
16-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Mysore
18-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Shivamogga(Rangayana)
19-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Putturu(Kadumane)
21-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Tumakuru
22-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Mandya
24-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Chintamani
28-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Kalenahalli
30-04-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Shiralakopp/Machikoppa
03-05-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Nallakadirenahalli
05-05-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Rangashankara/Bangalore
18-05-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Aaladahalli
21-05-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Gadaga
25-05-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Totadaaryamata, Gadaga
27-05-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Lakkalakatti/Dambala
28-05-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Badami
01-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	BEL Bangalore
02-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Bangalore University
03-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	K H Kalasouda
04-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Channnapattana
05-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Madduru
06-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Basaral
07-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Koppa
08-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Kalagrama(Mallatalli)
09-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Mysore
10-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Tipaturu
11-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	RPC Layout Vijayanagara
12-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Vaichakuranahalli
13-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Idaguru
14-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Doddaarasinakere
15-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Kottatti
16-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	K M Doddi

17-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Kyatanahalli
18-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Koppa
19-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Melukote/Bannangadi
20-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	K R Pete
21-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Tumakuru
22-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Channagiri
23-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Jindal(Toranagallu)
24-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Gajendragada
25-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Ilakal
26-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Sulebavi
27-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Koppala
28-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Siraguppa
29-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Sanehalli
30-06-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Shira
01-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Idaguru
03-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Karalli
04-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Kilara
05-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Mysore
06-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Darasaguppe
08-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Udupi
09-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Mangalore
10-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Soudatti
11-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Hubballi
12-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Gubbi
14-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Melehalli
15-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Hulikunte
16-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Sirigeri
17-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Hanagavadi
18-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Shira
19-07-2018	KURUKSHETHRA	Vadi
16-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Sakaleshpura
17-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Rakshidi
18-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Honnallimata
19-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Channarayapattana
20-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Channagiri
21-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Shrageri
23-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Suraleshwara/Hanagal
24-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Dharavada
27-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Sheshagiri
29-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Bangalore MES College
30-03-2019	KURUKSHETHRA	Bangalore



RESPONSE:

Most of the performances were followed by discussions with the audience, local organisers and media, and special invitees. These made for lively and rewarding sessions, which consisted of feedback, critical observations, questions, seeking of clarifications from the audience, and a general summing up by expert moderators. The production received high acclaim from all sections. Patrons communicated their appreciation orally, formally as well as informally, through letters and reviews published in various periodicals and newspapers, and through comments on social media platforms like facebook. Enclosed here are some reports/reviews of the production from a couple of years ago when Kurukshethra was making waves even after two years of its premiering.



ಸಾಹಿತ್ಯ-ಸಂಸ್ಕೃತಿ-ರಾಜಕಾರಣ ಚರ್ಚಾ : ಕೆಲವು ಬದ್ಧತೆಗಳು

-ಡಿಎಸ್‌ಎನ್

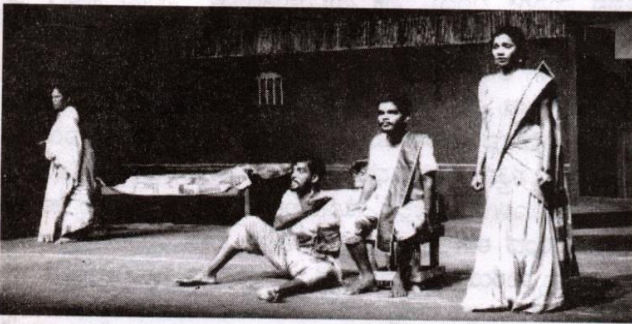


ಅರ್ಥೈಸುವ ಪ್ರಯತ್ನ ಮಾಡುವ ಈ ನಾಟಕ ಆ ಸೂಕ್ಷ್ಮಗಳೆಲ್ಲ ಹಿನ್ನೆಲೆಗೆ ಸರಿಯುವಂತಹ ಅಬ್ಬರದ ನಿರೂಪಣೆಯಿಂದಾಗಿ ತನ್ನ ನವಿರನ್ನೆಲ್ಲ ಕಳೆದುಕೊಂಡು ಬಹುಸ್ಥೂಲವಾಗಿ ನಿರೂಪಿತವಾಯಿತು. ಇದಕ್ಕೆ ನಟನಾ ತಂಡದ ಸೀಮಿತ ಪ್ರತಿಭೆಯಷ್ಟೇ ಕಾರಣವಿರಲಾರದೆಂದು ನನಗೆ ಅನಿಸಿದ್ದು. ಸಾಮಾಜಿಕ ಕಾಳಜಿಗಳ ಬಗೆಗಿನ ವಿಶೇಷ ಆಸಕ್ತಿಯಿಂದ ಅಂತಹ ನಾಟಕಗಳನ್ನು ಸಮರ್ಥವಾಗಿ ನಿರ್ದೇಶಿಸುವ ಗಣೇಶ್ ಅವರಿಗೆ ಅವರ ಈ ವಿಶೇಷ ಆಸಕ್ತಿಯೇ ಇಂತಹ ನಾಟಕಗಳ ಸೂಕ್ಷ್ಮ ಆಳಗಳನ್ನು ಅರಿತು ರಂಗವ್ಯಾಖ್ಯಾನ ಮಾಡುವಾಗ ತೊಡಕನ್ನುಂಟು ಮಾಡಿರಬಹುದು ಎಂಬ ಸಂದೇಹದಿಂದಾಗಿ.

ಆದರೆ ಒಂದೆರಡು ದಿನಗಳ ನಂತರ ಅವರೇ ತಮ್ಮ ಸತ್ಯಶೋಧನ ರಂಗ ಸಮುದಾಯಕ್ಕಾಗಿ ನಿರ್ದೇಶಿಸಿದ ಕುರುಕ್ಷೇತ್ರ (ಮೂಲ: ಬಿ.ಪುಟ್ಟಸ್ವಾಮಯ್ಯ) ಕಂಪನಿ ನಾಟಕವನ್ನು ನೋಡಿದಾಗ ನನಗೆ ಗಣೇಶ್ ತಮ್ಮ ಈ ತೊಡಕನ್ನು ಪರಿಹರಿಸಿಕೊಳ್ಳಬಲ್ಲರೆಂಬ ಆಸೆ ಹುಟ್ಟಿದ್ದಂತೂ ನಿಜ! ನಮ್ಮ ರಂಗಭೂಮಿ ಚರಿತ್ರೆಯ ಕಳೆದೇ ಹೋಗಿರುವ ಒಂದು ಅಧ್ಯಾಯವನ್ನು ಅದರಲ್ಲೂ ವರ್ಣ-ವೈಭವಗಳೊಂದಿಗೆ ರಂಗದ ಮೇಲೆ ಯಶಸ್ವಿಯಾಗಿ ತಂದ ಈ ಪ್ರಯೋಗ ಹಿಂದೊಮ್ಮೆ ಪ್ರಯೋಗವನ್ನು ನೋಡಿದ್ದಾಗ ನನ್ನಲ್ಲಿ ಹುಟ್ಟಿದ್ದ ಅದೇ ಪ್ರಶ್ನೆಗಳು ಇನ್ನಷ್ಟು ಸ್ಪಷ್ಟವಾಗಿ ಮೂಡಿದವು. ಈ ರಂಗರೂಪವನ್ನು ಬಹುಸ್ಥೂಲವೆಂದು ಸಾರಾಸಗಟಾಗಿ ತಿರಸ್ಕರಿಸಿ ಅಲ್ಲಿಂದ ಕಡಿದುಕೊಂಡ ಬಂದಿರುವ ನಾವು ಆಧುನಿಕ ರಂಗಭೂಮಿಯ ಆರಾಧಕರು ಬಹು ದೊಡ್ಡ ತಪ್ಪು ಮಾಡಿದ್ದೇವೆಂದು ಈ ಆಧುನಿಕ ರಂಗಭೂಮಿ ಎದುರಿಸುತ್ತಿರುವ ನಾಟಕ ರಚನೆ ಮತ್ತು ಜನದೂರತೆಯ ಬಿಕ್ಕಟ್ಟುಗಳ ಮೂಲ ಇಲ್ಲೇ ಇರಬಹುದೇ? ಈ ಪ್ರದರ್ಶನ ನೋಡಿ ನನಗಾದ ಖುಷಿಗೆ ಇನ್ನೊಂದು ಕಾರಣವೆಂದರೆ ಸತ್ಯಶೋಧನ ತಂಡದ ನಟ-ನಟಿಯರ ರಂಗಕೌಶಲ್ಯಗಳು ಮತ್ತು ಅವರ ಅರ್ಪಣಾ ಮನೋಭಾವ. ಇಂತಹ ತಂಡಗಳಿರುವವರೆಗೆ ನಮ್ಮ ರಂಗಭೂಮಿ ತನ್ನ ಚರಿತ್ರೆಯ ನೆನಪುಗಳನ್ನು ಕಳೆದುಕೊಳ್ಳಲಾಗದು.

ಇದಲ್ಲದಕ್ಕೆ ಸಾಕ್ಷಿ ಎಂಬಂತೆ ಕೇರಳದ 'ಲೋಕಧರ್ಮಿ' ತಂಡ ಚಂದ್ರದಾಸನ್ ನಿರ್ದೇಶನದಲ್ಲಿ ಪ್ರದರ್ಶಿಸಿದ ಭಾಸ ವಿರಚಿತ ಕರ್ಣಾಭಾರಂನ ಮಲೆಯಾಳಿ ರೂಪ. ಕೇರಳ ರಂಗಭೂಮಿ ತನ್ನ ಸಾಂಸ್ಕೃತಿಕ ಪರಂಪರೆಯಿಂದ ಎಷ್ಟನ್ನೆಲ್ಲ, ಹೇಗೆಲ್ಲ ಹೀರಿಕೊಂಡು ಸಮೃದ್ಧವಾಗಿ ಬೆಳೆದಿದೆ ಎಂಬುದರ ಪ್ರಾತ್ಯಕ್ಷಿಕೆಯಂತಿತ್ತು ಈ ಪ್ರದರ್ಶನ, ಕಥಕ್ಕಳಿ, ಕಲರಿಪಟ್ಟು, ಮೋಹಿನಿಯಾಟ್ಟಂ ಮುಂತಾದ ಪಾರಂಪರಿಕ ರಂಗ ಕಲೆಗಳನ್ನು ಈ ನಾಟಕದ ಅಭಿನಯ ಸಮೃದ್ಧಿಗೆ ಮಾತ್ರವಲ್ಲ, ದೊಂದಿ ಬೆಳಕಿನ 'ದೃಶ್ಯ ಸಂಯೋಜನೆ ಮತ್ತು ಸಂಗೀತಕ್ಕೂ ಬಳಸಿಕೊಂಡು ಕರ್ಣನ

ಶಿವಮೊಗ್ಗದ ರಂಗೋತ್ಸವ-೨೦೧೮



ಶಿವಮೊಗ್ಗದ ರಂಗಾಯಣ ಏಪ್ರಿಲ್ ೧೪ರಿಂದ ಏಳು ದಿನಗಳ ಕಾಲ

ವಿಶ್ವಮಾನವ ಅಂತಾರಾಷ್ಟ್ರೀಯ ರಂಗೋತ್ಸವ-೨೦೧೮'ನ್ನು ಏರ್ಪಡಿಸಿತ್ತು. ಅಷ್ಟೂ ದಿನ ಮಹಿಳಾ ಏಕವ್ಯಕ್ತಿ ಪ್ರದರ್ಶನ, ಮಕ್ಕಳ ಚಲನಚಿತ್ರ ಮತ್ತು ಬಹುಭಾಷಾ ಮತ್ತು ಬಹು ಪ್ರಕಾರಗಳ ರಂಗ ಪ್ರದರ್ಶನ ಮತ್ತು ರಂಗಚರ್ಚೆಗಳನ್ನು ಏರ್ಪಡಿಸಿತ್ತು. ಈ ಉತ್ಸವದ ಸಂಜೆಯ ನಾಟಕಗಳ ಪೈಕಿ ನಾನು ನೋಡಿದ ಐದು ನಾಟಕಗಳ ಪೈಕಿ ಮೂರರ ಬಗ್ಗೆ ಮಾತ್ರ ನಾನಿಲ್ಲಿ ಬರೆಯುತ್ತಿದ್ದೇನೆ. ಅವುಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಮೊದಲನೆಯದು ರಂಗಾಯಣದ ನಿರ್ದೇಶಕರೂ ಆಗಿರುವ ಡಾ. ಎಂ. ಗಣೇಶ್ ಅವರು ಸಂಸ್ಥೆಯ ಅಧಿಕೃತ ರಂಗತಂಡ (ರೇಪರ್ಲಿ)ಕ್ಕಾಗಿ ನಿರ್ದೇಶಿಸಿದ ಮೋಹನ ರಾಕೇಶ್ ಅವರ ಬಹು ಜನಪ್ರಿಯ ನಾಟಕ (ಮತ್ತು ಸಿದ್ಧಲಿಂಗ ಪಟ್ಟಣಶೆಟ್ಟಿಯವರು ಬಹು ಸೊಗಸಾಗಿ ಕನ್ನಡಕ್ಕೆ ತಂದಿರುವ) 'ಆಷಾಢದ ಒಂದು ದಿನ'. ಕಾಳಿದಾಸನ ಒಂದು ಪ್ರೇಮ ಕಥಾನಕದ ದುರಂತವನ್ನು ಹಲವು ಬಹು ಸೂಕ್ಷ್ಮ ನೆಲೆಗಳಿಂದ



(೧೮ನೇ ಪುಟಕ್ಕೆ

ಚಿನೇ ಪುಟದಿಂದ)

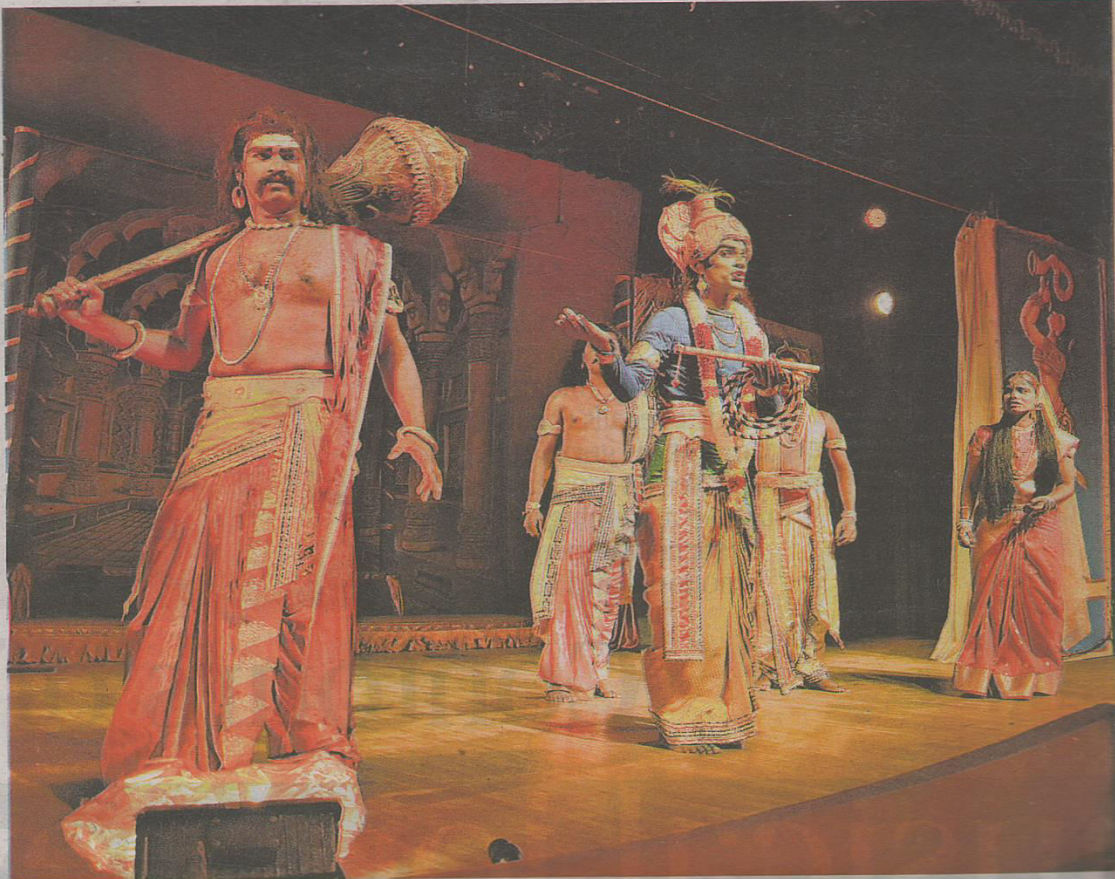
ದುರಂತ ಪ್ರಸಂಗವನ್ನು ಇಡೀ ಮಹಾಭಾರತದ ಕಥಾ ಭಿತ್ತಿಯ ಹಿನ್ನೆಲೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಕೇವಲ ಏಳೆಂಟು ಜನರ ನಟನಾ ತಂಡದ ಮೂಲಕ ತನ್ನದೇ ವ್ಯಾಖ್ಯಾನದೊಂದಿಗೆ ಕಟ್ಟಿಕೊಟ್ಟ ನಿರ್ದೇಶಕರ ರಂಗಕೌಶಲ ಅದ್ಭುತವೆನಿಸುವಂತಿತ್ತು. ಈ ಪ್ರದರ್ಶನವನ್ನು ಅಷ್ಟಾಗಿ ಮೆಚ್ಚಿದ -ಬಹುಶಃ ಅದರ ವ್ಯಾಖ್ಯಾನದ ಕಾರಣದಿಂದಾಗಿ-ಗಣೇಶ್, 'ನಿಮಗೆ ನಾಟಕವೊಂದರ ದರ್ಶನೀಯತೆ ಬಹುಮುಖ್ಯ ಎಂದು ಕಾಣುತ್ತದೆ' ಎಂದರು. ಹೌದು ನಾಟಕ ನಮಗೆ ಅಂತಿಮವಾಗಿ ಮನಸ್ಸಿಗೆ ತಟ್ಟುವುದು ಮೊದಲು ಕಣ್ಣು ಅದರ ಜೊತೆಯಲ್ಲೇ ಕಿವಿಗಳನ್ನು ಅರಳಿಸುವ ಮೂಲಕ. ನಮ್ಮ ಪಾರಂಪರಿಕ ನಾಟಕ ಕಲೆಯ ಈ ಮೂಲ ಪಾಠ ಮತ್ತು ಉಪಾಯವನ್ನೇ ನಾವು ಮರೆತಂತಿದೆ. ನಮ್ಮ ಗಮನವೆಲ್ಲ ನಾಟಕವಾಗಿ ನೇರವಾಗಿ ಕಣ್ಣು ಕಿವಿಗಳಿಲ್ಲದ ಮನಸ್ಸಿಗೆ-ಅಂದರೆ ಮಿದುಳಿಗೇ ನಾಟಿಸುವ ಪ್ರಯತ್ನವಾದಂತಿದೆ' ಎಂದೆ ನಾನು.

ನಾನು ನೋಡಿದ ಇನ್ನೆರಡು ಪ್ರಯೋಗಗಳ ಪೈಕಿ ರಂಗಾಯಣದ ರೆಪರ್ಟರಿಗಾಗಿ ಸವಿತಾರಾಣಿಯವರು ನಿರ್ದೇಶಿಸಿದ 'ಟ್ರಾನ್ಸ್‌ನೇಷನ್'.ರೆಪರ್ಟರಿಯ ನಟ-ನಟಿಯರನ್ನು ನವನವೀನ ಪ್ರಯೋಗಗಳಿಗೆ ಒಳಪಡಿಸುವ ಮೂಲಕ ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ ರಂಗ ತಂಡವಾಗಿ ಬೆಳೆಸಬಹುದು ಎಂಬ ಆಸೆ ಹುಟ್ಟಿಸಿದ್ದರ ಹೊರತಾಗಿ ಮತ್ತಾವ ಸಂದೇಶವನ್ನೂ ನೀಡಲಾಗದಷ್ಟು ಮಹತ್ವಾಕಾಂಕ್ಷೆಯನ್ನು ತನ್ನ ತಲೆಯ ಮೇಲೆ ಹೊತ್ತು ಬಳಲಿದರೆ, ಈ ರಂಗೋತ್ಸವಕ್ಕೆ ಅಂತಾರಾಷ್ಟ್ರೀಯವೆಂಬ ಅಭಿದಾನ ನೀಡಿದ ಸಿಂಗಪುರದ ತಂಡವೊಂದರ 'ವೆನ್ ವಿ ಡೆಡ್ ಅವೇಕನ್' ಎಂಬ ಪ್ರಯೋಗವು ನಾನೂ ಸೇರಿದಂತೆ ಬಹಳ ಜನರಿಗೆ ಸಾಂಕೇತಿಕತೆಯ ಹೆಸರಿನ ಹುಚ್ಚಾಟವಾಗಿದ್ದಂತೆ ಕಂಡರೂ ಕೆಲವರಿಗೆ ಅದರ ಸಾಂಕೇತಿಕ ರಂಗಕೌಶಲ್ಯಗಳಿಗಾಗಿ ಇಷ್ಟವಾಯಿತಂತೆ. ನಾನು ಅಷ್ಟು ಸೂಕ್ಷ್ಮ ನಲ್ಲವೇನೋ, ತಿಳಿಯದು!



A scene from Kurukshethra (Janamanadata 2018-19), Dir. by Dr. M. Ganesha

Conjuring up
good old
days A scene
from
Kurukshetra



Company drama in contemporary times

A bunch of youngsters bring to stage B. Puttaswamayya's play, Kurukshetra. Directed by M. Ganesh, presently the director of Rangayana, Shimoga, the play attempts to revive the magic of good old times

MANASA KAMBANNA

"Making arrows from bamboo sticks, smearing mud all over the body and wearing fowl feathers, me and my shepherd friends used to recreate the breathtaking drama scenes that we had watched the previous night.

I grew up watching drama company plays and everything about them had created a fascination in me," recollects Dr. M. Ganesh, who taught theatre at Ninasam, and presently Director, Rangayana Shimoga. All night plays based on Ramayana, Mahabharata and other puranas were common in most villages during summer when agricultural activities would take a halt. Setting up of the stage itself, he says, brought a magical world into the rural space and the whole practice was to amuse villagers who were exhausted from a yearlong labour.

Kurukshetra, a play direct-

ed by Ganesh is being staged all over the State: it takes its inspiration from company plays. The whole village would come alive with total participation. With this culture slowly fading away, "my childhood memories impelled me to reinvigorate, staging it in not only villages, but also in urban and semi-urban areas," says Ganesh, who has trained amateurs of Sathyashodhana Ranga Samudaya every night for a whole month.

This plot of Kurukshetra has over the years taken various forms with each troupe improvising it by altering the dialogues, scenes and songs. One of the versions of the play was called *Sri Krishna Sandhaana*, made famous by Gubbi Company. "We kept all those versions in mind while drafting the play and selected the aspects that would add value to our version."

The group based the play majorly on B. Puttaswamayya's *Kurukshetra* and took the

essence of *Smashana Kurukshetra* by Kuvempu where Krishna unravels the truth of existence to Duryodhana during his death. "We are also grateful to theatre masters P. Vajrappa and Kalloru Srinivasa as we adapted a lot from their models as well," he

The plot of Kurukshetra has over the years taken various forms with each troupe improvising it adds.

This Kurukshetra, he explains, is a family drama which involves fights between cousins, the Pandavas and the Kauravas, helplessness of Karna, the first son of Kunti, grudge of Duryodhana against his rivals and the agony of Gandhari who is placed in a difficult situation where she cannot stop her son from resorting to war. To replicate

the old style of presentation, "the actors themselves sing and the whole play is a musical treat."

The troupe has incurred an expenditure of four lakhs for this production. "The sharing of profits equally among all the actors and technicians without any regard to the role or seniority is what makes the troupe special," he mentions.

The intention of this new play is "to recreate the purpose and glory of folk style. In providing a taste of rural drama, we hope the style and technique of this form would survive," says Ganesh.

The troupe has rendered 20 shows at various places including Thirthahalli, Mandya, Puttur, Mysore, Kunigal and Sira.

It will be staged in Bangalore at Rangashankara on May 5, 7.30 p.m. Tickets are priced at Rs. 150 and can be bought at the venue or booked online on www.book-myshow.com.



drashekar (middle)

ACHIEVEMENTS:

The following point to the output and achievements of Janamanadata:

- Janamanadata, a theatre repertory, has been working continuously from 2005, producing plays on a regular basis every since then.
- It has travelled over most parts of Karnataka every year and even outside its boundaries on some occasions.
- An average of 500 people have watched each Janamanadata show every year between 2005-18.
- Special mention can be made of Mandya district, where alone immense public demand made us stage 15 shows. About 1,500 people used to gather for each show of Kurukshethra, sometimes putting up their own sets and properties and requesting us to perform using them.
- The project has worked with highly regarded directors from inside as also outside Karnataka.
- Proper accounts and documents have been maintained all through the years of the project.
- Detailed documentation of the project activities is being done through photographs, slides, videos, and news clippings and reviews.

The project has been lauded for the professional quality as well as the artistic merit of its works, which according to many is easily comparable to those of any major theatre troupe or project in India.